

Figure 6 | EIA interpretation matrix

External persistence

Persistent

**3 Gain persistent externally
(provenance unclear)**

Gain survives an independent evaluation environment; source not yet separated from representation.

**4 Independent provenance
+ external persistence**

Strongest: gain persists externally AND is not explained by dependent provenance. Supports attribution.

Not persistent

**1 Performance gain
observed**

Delta > 0 within the original ecology. Weakest claim; does not establish information attribution.

**2 Gain under independent
provenance**

Provenance control fails to remove the gain without independent evidence. Stronger, but still ecology-bound.

Not independent

Independent

Provenance independence